

How to Develop

The 14 Ways of 8 Attainments

The Recollection of Past Lives Abhiññā

&

Knowledge of Death & Rebirth of Beings:

Divine eye Abhiññā

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The 14 Ways of 8 Attainments Completely Control of The Mind

Numerical-charts designed & described by Pa-Auk Tawya Sayadaw Bhaddanta Āciṇṇa.
Special techniques suggested by Ayyā Citra-ñāṇī (Thai Sayalay), Pa-Auk Tawya.

The 8 attainments are:

- 1 = 1st jhāna
- 2 = 2nd jhāna
- 3 = 3rd jhāna
- 4 = 4th jhāna
- 5 = The Base of Boundless Space (the object is 'the infinite space')
- 6 = The Base of Boundless Consciousness (the object is 'the consciousness of the Base of Boundless Space')
- 7 = The Base of Nothingness (the object is 'the absence of consciousness of the Base of Boundless Space')
- 8 = The Base of Neither Perception Nor Non-perception (the object is 'the consciousness of the Base of Nothingness')

In order to completely control the mind, one should practice 8 attainments by 14 ways hundred times, thousand times until attain 8 factors, which are purified, bright, unblemished, rid of defilement, and has become malleable, wieldy, steady, and attain to imperturbability. Only then it will be easy to attain clear Direct Knowledges and Path & Fruition Knowledges. The 14 ways of 8 attainments are:

- I. **Kasiṇa anuloma** (in the forward order of kasiṇas)
- II. **Kasiṇa paṭiloma** (in the reverse order of kasiṇas)
- III. **Kasiṇa anuloma paṭiloma** (in the forward and reverse order of kasiṇas)
- IV. **Jhāna anuloma** (in the forward order of Jhānas)
- V. **Jhāna paṭiloma** (in the reverse order of Jhānas)
- VI. **Jhāna anuloma paṭiloma** (in the forward and reverse order of Jhānas)
- VII. **Jhāna-ukkantika** (skipping Jhānas)
- VIII. **Kasiṇa-ukkantika** (skipping Kasiṇas)
- IX. **Jhāna-Kasiṇa-ukkantika** (skipping Jhānas and Kasiṇas)
- X. **Āṅgasaṅkantika** (transposition of factors)
- XI. **Ārammaṇa saṅkantika** (transposition of object)
- XII. **Āṅgārammaṇa saṅkantika** (transposition of factors and object)
- XIII. **Āṅga vavaṭṭhāpana** (definition of factors)
- XIV. **Ārammaṇa vavaṭṭhāpana** (definition of object)

Special Techniques (suggested by Ayyā Citra-ñāṇī: Thai Sayalay)

Generally, for each way:

1) I reflected on the 9 Attributes of The Buddha & His Great Compassion until I was very much happy.

2) I always "smile" while practising because the perception of bliss (Sukha) and the perception of lightness (Lahutā) are the basis for all higher attainments (suggested by Venerable Saṅgārāma and also in Visuddhimagga). Whenever it's difficult, tensions will arise. Smiling can drive away either physical or mental tensions, then I was able to continue practising again.

How to practise 14 Ways?

I. Kasiṇa anuloma (in the forward order of kasiṇas)

For every kasiṇa, practise from the 1st to the 8th attainment.

(Emphasize on the sequence of kasiṇas)

Pathavī (earth kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Āpo (water kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Tejo (fire kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Vāyo (wind kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Nīla (black kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Pīta (yellow kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Lohita (red kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Odāta (white kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)

Then practise from Pathavī 1~8...till Odāta 1~8 again & again as quickly as possible.

II. Kasiṇa paṭiloma (in the reverse order of kasiṇas)

For every kasiṇa, practise from the 1st to the 8th attainment.

(From the White kasiṇa to the Earth kasiṇa)

Odāta (white kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Lohita (red kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Pīta (yellow kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Nīla (black kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Vāyo (wind kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Tejo (fire kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Āpo (water kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Pathavī (earth kasiṇa) →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)

Then practise from Odāta 1 ~ 8...till Pathavī 1 ~ 8 again & again as quickly as possible.

III. Kasiṇa anuloma paṭiloma (in the forward and reverse order of kasiṇas)

Practise the 8 kasiṇa in the forward order, and then reverse order.

1) Pathavī →	1 ~ 8	2) Odāta →	1 ~ 8
Āpo →	1 ~ 8	Lohita →	1 ~ 8
Tejo →	1 ~ 8	Pīta →	1 ~ 8
Vāyo →	1 ~ 8	Nīla →	1 ~ 8
Nīla →	1 ~ 8	Vāyo →	1 ~ 8
Pīta →	1 ~ 8	Tejo →	1 ~ 8
Lohita →	1 ~ 8	Āpo →	1 ~ 8
Odāta →	1 ~ 8	Pathavī →	1 ~ 8

After finished the 3rd way again & again as quickly as possible, then practise the 1st to 3rd ways continuously again & again as quickly as possible.

IV. Jhāna anuloma (in the forward order of jhānas)

For every kasiṇa, practise from the 1st to 8th attainment. (Emphasize on the sequence of jhānas)

Pathavī →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Āpo →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Tejo →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Vāyo →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Nīla →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Pīta →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Lohita →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)
Odāta →	1 ~ 8 (again & again till very quick)

Then practise from Pathavī 1~8...till Odāta 1~8 again & again as quickly as possible.

After finished the 4th way again & again as quickly as possible, then practise the 1st to 4th ways continuously again & again as quickly as possible.

V. **Jhāna paṭiloma** (in the reverse order of Jhānas)

-Practise the Earth kasiṇa to enter from the 8th to 1st attainment. (If it is difficult to do so, you should first practise it to enter from the 1st to 8th attainment, and then enter from the 8th to 1st attainment.)

-Then practise the Water kasiṇa to enter from the 8th to 1st attainment. (If it is difficult to do so...(as above)).

- The remaining kasiṇas should be practised in the same way.

Pathavī	→	8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Āpo	→	8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Tejo	→	8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Vāyo	→	8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Nīla	→	8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Pīta	→	8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Lohita	→	8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Odāta	→	8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)

Then practise from Pathavī 8 ~ 1...till Odāta 8 ~ 1 again & again as quickly as possible.

After finished the 5th way, then practise the 1st to 5th ways continuously again & again as quickly as possible.

VI. **Jhāna anuloma paṭiloma** (in the forward and reverse order of Jhānas)

-Practise every kasiṇa to enter from the 1st to 8th attainment, and then enter from the 8th to 1st attainment.

Pathavī	→	1 ~ 8, 8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Āpo	→	1 ~ 8, 8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Tejo	→	1 ~ 8, 8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Vāyo	→	1 ~ 8, 8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Nīla	→	1 ~ 8, 8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Pīta	→	1 ~ 8, 8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Lohita	→	1 ~ 8, 8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)
Odāta	→	1 ~ 8, 8 ~ 1 (again & again till very quick)

Then practise from Pathavī 1~8, 8~1...till Odāta 1~8, 8~1 again & again as quickly as possible.

After finished the 6th way, then practise the 1st to 6th ways continuously again & again as quickly as possible.

VII. **Jhāna-ukkantika** (skipping Jhānas)

-Practise the Earth kasiṇa to enter from the 1st, 3rd, 5th and 7th attainments, then enter from the 2nd, 4th, 6th and 8th attainments...until the 8th, 2nd, 4th and 6th attainments.

-The remaining kasiṇa should be practised in the same way.

For example:

Pathavī only	→	1→3→5→7
		2→4→6→8
		3→5→7→1
		4→6→8→2
		5→7→1→3
		6→8→2→4
		7→1→3→5
		8→2→4→6
Practise again & again till very quick.		

- Then practise Āpo, Tejo, Vāyo, Nīla, Pīta, Lohita, and Odāta in the same way.
- Then practise from Pathavī to Odāta again & again till very quick.
- Then practise from the 1st to 7th ways continuously again & again till very quick.

VIII. Kasiṇa-ukkantika (skipping Kasiṇas)

-First, practise to enter only the 1st jhāna from the Earth, Fire, Brown to Red kasiṇa; then from the Water, Wind, Yellow to White kasiṇa...until you practise from the White, Water, Wind to Yellow kasiṇa.

-Then practise from the Earth, Fire, Brown to Red kasiṇa but enter only the 2nd jhāna directly. Practise in this way until you finish all the 8 attainments.

For example:

Enter 1 st jhāna only			
→ Pathavī	→ Tejo	→ Nīla	→ Lohita
Āpo	→ Vāyo	→ Pīta	→ Odāta
Tejo	→ Nīla	→ Lohita	→ Pathavī
Vāyo	→ Pīta	→ Odāta	→ Āpo
Nīla	→ Lohita	→ Pathavī	→ Tejo
Pīta	→ Odāta	→ Āpo	→ Vāyo
Lohita	→ Pathavī	→ Tejo	→ Nīla
Odāta	→ Āpo	→ Vāyo	→ Pīta

Then enter directly 2nd jhāna only...then 3rd jhāna only...then 4th jhāna only...then 5th only...then 6th only...then 7th only...then 8th only.

Then practise from the 1st to 8th ways continuously again & again till very quick.

IX. Jhāna-Kasiṇa-ukkantika (skipping Jhānas and Kasiṇas)

-Practise **1**, the first sequence of kasiṇas, according to the first column:

First, enter the 1st jhāna of the Earth kasiṇa, then the 3rd jhāna of the Fire kasiṇa, then the Base of Boundless Space of the Brown kasiṇa, then the Base of Nothingness of the Red kasiṇa.... until the Base of Nothingness of the White kasiṇa.

-Then practise according to the second column:

First, enter the 2nd jhāna of the Earth kasiṇa, then the 4th jhāna of the Fire kasiṇa, then the Base of Boundless Consciousness of the Brown kasiṇa, then the Base of Neither Perception Nor Non-perception of the Red kasiṇa.... until the Base of Neither Perception Nor Non-perception of the White kasiṇa.

-Then practise according to the third column...until you finish all 8 columns.

-In the same way, practise **2**, the second sequence of kasiṇas...until you finish **8**, the eight sequence of kasiṇas.

1

Pathavī	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Tejo	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
Nīla	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
Lohita	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
Āpo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Vāyo	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
Pīta	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
Odāta	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6

2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Āpo	Tejo	Vāyo	Nīla	Pīta	Lohita	Odāta
Vāyo	Nīla	Pīta	Lohita	Odāta	Pathavī	Āpo
Pīta	Lohita	Odāta	Pathavī	Āpo	Tejo	Vāyo
Odāta	Pathavī	Āpo	Tejo	Vāyo	Nīla	Pīta
Tejo	Vāyo	Nīla	Pīta	Lohita	Odāta	Pathavī
Nīla	Pīta	Lohita	Odāta	Pathavī	Āpo	Tejo
Lohita	Odāta	Pathavī	Āpo	Tejo	Vāyo	Nīla
Pathavī	Āpo	Tejo	Vāyo	Nīla	Pīta	Lohita

Special technique for the ninth way: (suggested by Ayyā Citra-nāṇī : Thai Sayalay)

- 1) I wrote all 8 sequences of kasiṇas by separated each sequence into set a (a1-a4), and set b (b1-b4) (which will be shown in the next page).
- 2) I learnt by heart the 8 pairs of set a & set b,

Set a1: Pathavī-Tejo-Nīla-Lohita
 a2: Tejo-Nīla-Lohita-Pathavī
 a3: Nīla-Lohita-Pathavī-Tejo
 a4: Lohita-Pathavī-Tejo-Nīla

Set b1: Āpo-Vāyo-Pīta-Odāta
 b2: Vāyo-Pīta-Odāta-Āpo
 b3: Pīta-Odāta-Āpo-Vāyo
 b4: Odāta-Āpo-Vāyo-Pīta

[The 1st sequence is a1+b1, the 2nd sequence is b1+a2, the 3rd sequence is a2+b2, the 4th sequence is b2+a3, the 5th sequence is a3+b3, the 6th sequence is b3+a4, the 7th sequence is a4+b4, and the 8th sequence is b4+a1]

- 3) Having learnt by heart thus, then before practising I again reflected on the 9 Attributes of The Buddha & His Great Compassion until I was very much happy.
- 4) In order to practise well I had to use my fingers as helpers by:
 - 4.1) On the right hand, I marked one finger by one sequence; for example, I marked the right thumb as "Pathavī" because the first sequence begins with Pathavī kasiṇa. {This marked finger as "Pathavī" also reminded me to remember that when finished set a1 of Pathavī, then set b1 will begin with "Āpo"}. Then after finished skipping of the first sequence (set a1+b1 all 8 columns), I marked the right index finger as "Āpo" because the second sequence begins with Āpo kasiṇa.... in this way even though my right hand has only 5 fingers but I had to mark until finished the last eight sequence as "Odāta".
 - 4.2) On the left hand, I marked one finger by one column; for example, in the first sequence (a1+b1) there are 8 columns (1 to 8), In the first column I marked the left thumb as "1" (which means the 1st jhāna) by entering set a1 from Pathavī-1st jhāna, then skipped to Tejo-3rd jhāna, Nīla-5th jhāna, Lohita-7th jhāna, then set b1 from Āpo-1st jhāna, Vāyo-3rd jhāna, Pīta-5th jhāna, Odāta-7th jhāna. After finished the first column, I marked the left index finger as "2"(which means the 2nd jhāna)...in this way until finished all 8 columns of the first sequence (set a1+b1).
- 5) Whenever I could not remember or tension arose, I smiled to cool down my mind, and then I could continue. The perception of bliss & lightness are very benefit while practising any of the 14 ways.
- 6) It's not able to do only 1 sequence by one sitting, but I had to do from the 1st to 8th sequences (of the ninth way) continuously in the same sitting.
- 7) After finished the 9th way, I directed the mind to do quicker & quicker by just directing with smiling mind until it reached uncountable rounds in a minute.

The 8 sequences of the 9th Way by special technique

1

a1	Pathavī	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Tejo	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Nīla	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Lohita	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
b1	Āpo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Vāyo	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Pīta	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Odāta	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6

2

b1	Āpo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Vāyo	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Pīta	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Odāta	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
a2	Tejo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Nīla	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Lohita	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Pathavī	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6

3

a2	Tejo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Nīla	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Lohita	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Pathavī	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
b2	Vāyo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Pīta	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Odāta	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Āpo	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6

4

b2	Vāyo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Pīta	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Odāta	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Āpo	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
a3	Nīla	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Lohita	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Pathavī	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Tejo	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6

5

a3	Nīla	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Lohita	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Pathavī	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Tejo	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
b3	Pīta	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Odāta	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Āpo	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Vāyo	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6

6

b3	Pīta	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Odāta	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Āpo	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Vāyo	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
a4	Lohita	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Pathavī	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Tejo	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Nīla	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6

7

a4	Lohita	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Pathavī	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Tejo	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Nīla	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
b4	Odāta	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Āpo	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Vāyo	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Pīta	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6

8

b4	Odāta	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Āpo	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Vāyo	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Pīta	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
a1	Pathavī	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Tejo	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
	Nīla	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
	Lohita	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6

When finished, then direct the mind, with the perception of bliss and the perception of lightness, repeat the 9th way from the 1st to 8th sequences peacefully again & again till very quick. Then practise from the 1st to 9th ways continuously again & again till very quick.

X.Āṅgasaṅkantika (transposition of factors)

-Practise to enter the 1st jhāna of the Earth kasīṇa. After emerging from it, observe its jhāna factors (i.e. discerning only one by one jhāna factor at Bhavaṅga, not to discern them

together). Then enter the 2nd jhāna, emerge and then discern only one by one jhāna factor... until you finish all the 8 attainments. The way here is to notice the changing of the jhāna factors.

-You should practise in the same way from the Water kasiṇa to the White kasiṇa. You should discern only one by one jhāna factor of every jhāna.

Pathavī	→	1 ~ 8
Āpo	→	1 ~ 8
Tejo	→	1 ~ 8
Vāyo	→	1 ~ 8
Nīla	→	1 ~ 8
Pīta	→	1 ~ 8
Lohita	→	1 ~ 8
Odāta	→	1 ~ 8

Then practise from the 1st to 10th ways continuously again & again till very quick.

XI.Ārammaṇa saṅkantika (transposition of object): It is the practice of changing the object.

-Practise to enter only the 1st jhāna of every kasiṇa. Then practise to enter only the 2nd jhāna. Then practise to enter only the 3rd jhāna... until finish all 8 attainments.

↓ Pathavī	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Āpo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Tejo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Vāyo	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Nīla	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Pīta	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Lohita	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Odāta	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

Then practise from the 1st to 11th ways continuously again & again till very quick.

XII.Āngārammaṇa saṅkantika (transposition of factors and object)

-Practise according to the first column: enter from the 1st jhāna of the Earth kasiṇa, then enter the 2nd jhāna of the Water kasiṇa, then enter the 3rd jhāna of the Fire kasiṇa... until enter the Base of Neither Perception Nor Non-perception of the White kasiṇa.

-Then practise according to the second column: enter from the 2nd jhāna of the Earth kasiṇa, then enter the 3rd jhāna of the Water kasiṇa... until enter the 1st jhāna of the White kasiṇa.

-Then practise according to the third column... until finish all 8 columns.

↓ Pathavī	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Āpo	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	1
Tejo	3	4	5	6	7	8	1	2
Vāyo	4	5	6	7	8	1	2	3
Nīla	5	6	7	8	1	2	3	4
Pīta	6	7	8	1	2	3	4	5
Lohita	7	8	1	2	3	4	5	6
Odāta	8	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

-After finished all 8 columns then practise the 12th way again & again till very quick.

-Then practise from the 1st to 12th ways continuously again & again till very quick.

XIII. **Āṅga vavaṭṭhāpana** (definition of factors)

-Practise to enter the 1st jhāna of the Earth kasiṇa, emerge, and then define 'how many jhāna factors it has?' (i.e. discerning all 5 jhāna factors together at Bhavaṅga, not to discern one by one factor). Then enter the 2nd jhāna, emerge, and then define all 3 jhāna factors together which are joy (pīti), happiness (sukha) and one-pointedness (ekaggatā). Then enter the 3rd jhāna, emerge, and then define all 2 jhāna factors together, which are happiness (sukha) and one-pointedness (ekaggatā). Then enter the 4th jhāna, emerge, and then define all 2 jhāna factors together, which are equanimity (upekkhā) and one-pointedness (ekaggatā). Then enter the Base of Boundless Space or Ākāsānañcāyatana jhāna, the Base of Boundless Consciousness or Viññānañcāyatana jhāna, the Base of Nothingness or Ākiñcaññāyatana jhāna and the Base of Neither Perception Nor Non-perception or Nevasaññānāsaññāyatana jhāna successively and at each time define all 2 jhāna factors together (equanimity and one-pointedness) which is present in all the 4 Arūpa jhāna. Having entered these jhānas, the meditators must define all jhāna factors together after emerging from each respective jhāna.

-For the remaining kasiṇas should be defined jhāna factors of various jhānas in the same way. (1st jhāna has 5 factors, 2nd has 3 factors, 3rd has 2 factors, 4th- 8th each has 2 factors)

Pathavī	→	1 ~ 8
Āpo	→	1 ~ 8
Tejo	→	1 ~ 8
Vāyo	→	1 ~ 8
Nīla	→	1 ~ 8
Pīta	→	1 ~ 8
Lohita	→	1 ~ 8
Odāta	→	1 ~ 8

-After finished all 8 kasiṇas then practise the 13th way again & again till very quick.

-Then practise from the 1st to 13th ways continuously again & again till very quick.

XIV. **Ārammaṇa vavaṭṭhāpana** (definition of object)

-Practise to enter the 1st jhāna of the Earth kasiṇa, emerge, and then confirm that 'its object is the Earth kasiṇa'. Then enter the 2nd jhāna, emerge, and then confirm that 'its object is the Earth kasiṇa'... until after emerging from the 4th jhāna, emerge, and then confirm that 'its object is the Earth kasiṇa'.

-Then enter the Base of Boundless Space by removing the Earth kasiṇa. After emerging from it, confirm that 'its object is the infinite space'.

-Then enter the Base of Boundless Consciousness. After emerging from it, confirm that 'its object is the consciousness of the Base of Boundless Space'.

-Then enter the Base of Nothingness. After emerging from it, confirm that 'its object is the absence of the consciousness of the Base of Boundless Space'.

-Then enter the Base of Neither Perception Nor Non-perception. After emerging from it, confirm that 'its object is the consciousness of the Base of Nothingness'.

-The object of various jhānas of the remaining kasiṇas should be confirmed in the same way.

Pathavī	→	1 ~ 8
Āpo	→	1 ~ 8
Tejo	→	1 ~ 8
Vāyo	→	1 ~ 8
Nīla	→	1 ~ 8
Pīta	→	1 ~ 8
Lohita	→	1 ~ 8
Odāta	→	1 ~ 8

- After finished all 8 kasīṇas then practise the 14th way again & again till very quick.
- Then practise from the 1st to 14th ways continuously again & again till very quick.

After finished all 14 ways together, in order to completely control the mind, one should practice 8 attainments by 14 ways hundred times, thousand times until attain 8 factors, which are purified, bright, unblemished, rid of defilement, and has become malleable, wieldy, steady, and attain to imperturbability. Only then it will be easy to attain clear Direct Knowledges (mundane 5 Abhiññā) and Path & Fruition Knowledges or Supramundane Knowledges.

How to develop the 2 Direct Knowledges?

(Notes: this is a translation of Dhamma talk on Mahā Assapura Sutta in Burmese delivered by Pa-Auk Tawya Sayadaw Bhaddanta Āciṇṇa.)

Now, the 14 ways of mastery are completed. In this monastery, these 14 ways of practice are taught to the meditator only after he has realized the Peaceful Element, having meditated on these Jhāna Samāpatti by the 2 methods of Vipassanā meditation: Anupada-dhamma Vipassanā and Kalāpa Sammasana. Why is this so? Due to the power of the Samāpatti (i.e. the Concentration), the Vipassanāñāṇa (insight Knowledge) becomes sharp. Also, because of the power of Vipassanāñāṇa, the Samāpatti becomes more stable. If the Samāpatti are not "fasten" by the Vipassanāñāṇa then sometimes these Jhāna Samāpatti can decline. The concentration may be ruined. The meaning of Anupāda-dhamma Vipassanā is as follows: Let us say in Earth Kasīṇa, one enters into its 1st Jhāna. To enumerate the 1st Jhāna mental factors there are 34 of them. Meditate Vipassanā on each of these 34 mental factors one by one. For example "Consciousness (Citta), arising and passing away, Aniccā", "Contact (Phassa), arising and passing away, Aniccā" etc. "Feeling (Vedanā)..." Meditating on the three characteristics of Aniccā, Dukkā, Anattā (impermanent, suffering, non-self) of each individual mental factor, is called Anupada-dhamma Vipassanā method. If the insight becomes sharp and if changing to the insight at the stage of passing away only, then meditating only on the perishing away of each mental factor as Aniccā, Dukkā, Anattā is also called Anupada-dhamma Vipassanā. It is the same for the remaining Jhānas and Kasīṇas. Then, not meditating on the mental factor individually but by meditating on the 34 mental factors (of 1st jhāna) collectively as Aniccā, their nature of arising and passing away; as Dukkā, their nature of being constantly oppressed by arising and passing away; as, Anattā, having no soul, no indestructible essence is called Kalāpa Sammasana Vipassanā method or Neyya Vipassanā method. It is found that it is easy to teach (the 14 ways) to the meditator who has meditated on the 3 characteristic (Aniccā Dukkā Anattā) of the 8 Samāpatti by the Anupada-dhamma Vipassanā and Kalāpa Sammasana Vipassanā methods thoroughly. However it does not mean that it is not easy for the meditator who has not attained the Vipassanā insight yet. There may be some who find it easy, depending on their Pāramī (past perfections). But, accordingly to the Commentary, generally only one in a hundred or a thousand may be successful. Just a few of them who have attained Jhānas only are able to change to practice the Abhiññā. However, from the practical research on the meditators, when teaching it to those whose Vipassanā insight is matured, there are many who can achieve it. There is difference only in the sharpness of their knowledge. Therefore, as I have just mentioned, it is a proof that Vipassanā insight can make the Samāpatti more stable.

How to Develop the Recollection of Past Lives Abhiññā?

After training the mind by these 14 ways the meditator can change to the Psychic Powers. However it is mentioned that before that one should practice these 14 ways for a hundred times, a thousand times, for many times. Having gained mastery over the mind by these 14 ways, what should the

meditator further do? In the Mahā Assapura Sutta the Buddha taught the 11th cause for one to be called a Samaṇa (i.e. a monk):

So evaṃ samāhite citte parisuddhe pariyodāte anaṅgaṇe vigatūpakkilese mudubhūte kammaniye t̥hite āneñjappatte pubbenivāsānussatiñāṇāya cittaṃ abhininnāmeti. (Majjhima Nikāya)

The meditator who is going to change to the Abhiññā must enter into the 4th Jhāna again after practicing the 14 ways of mastery. A piece of gold, which is purified, is adaptable or workable. It is ready to be shaped into the various ornaments. Similarly the mind that has been well trained by the 14 ways (and after it has re-entered into the 4th Jhāna as the Basis Jhāna) is pure (parisuddha), brilliantly bright (pariyodāta) free from lust (anaṅgaṇa), free from defilements (vigatūpakkilesa), pliant (mudubhūta), adaptable (Kammaniya-it mean that if he wishes to practise the Recollection of Past Lives Abhiññā, it is easy; if he wishes to practise the Divine Eye Abhiññā, it is easy; if he wishes to practise Vipassanā meditation then it is easy. The mind is adaptable to the various meditation), stable (t̥hita), unshakable (āneñjappatta). The mind is stable and firm on the object of meditation. Other objects cannot come in. The meditator has mastery over the mind.

Then he inclines the mind to the knowledge of the Recollection of Past Lives (Pubbenivāsānussatiñāṇa). That monk (i.e. the meditator) discerns many past lives by his insight. That is, (recollecting) one live, two lives, three lives, four lives, five lives, ten lives, twenty lives, thirty lives, forty lives, fifty lives, a hundred lives, a thousand lives, a hundred thousand lives, many Saṃvaṭṭa Kappa, many Vivaṭṭa Kappa. If he discerns a past live then he knows exactly the following concerning that past live:

- 1) Evaṃ Nāmo - the name he was called in that live
- 2) Evaṃ Gotto - the clan or race then; whether he was a Chinese or Indian or Burmese in that live.
- 3) Evaṃ Vaṇṇo - the complexion then; whether he was handsome or not in that live
- 4) Evamāharo - the kind of food eaten in that live
- 5) Evaṃ sukhadukkhappaṭisaṃvedī-both the happy and painful experience in that live.
- 6) Evamāyupariyanto - the life span in that life.

He then discerns that having passed away in that past live he was reborn in another past existence. He can also discern the name, clan, complexion, etc...of that past existence. He can discern like that from one past live to another; one after another. The destruction of a world cycle and the arising of a world cycle (Saṃvaṭṭa Kappa and Vivaṭṭa Kappa) can also be discerned by him. He knows the destruction, then arising, then continuance, then destruction of world cycles. The meditator can discern how a world cycle comes to exist by Recollection of Past Lives.

This is a Sutta where the Buddha taught that a disciple of the Buddha (Savaka) can attain Recollection of Past Lives by teaching it as the 11th cause for one to be called a 'monk', a samaṇa. Then the Buddha further taught about it by mentioning a parable. A man goes from his own village to a second village; then from that second village he goes to a third village; then from the third village he returns to his own village. Then it may occur in his thoughts that "I went from my own village to the second village. In that second village I stood in such a way, sat in such a way, spoke in such a way, became silent in such a way. And from that second village I went to the third village. In that third village I stood in such a way, sat in such a way, spoke in such a way, became silent in such a way. Then I return from that 3rd village to my own village." When he reflects like this does it not arise in sequence? It does. In the same (as the parable) the Buddha taught that the meditator discerns manifold past lives by his insight.

How many kind of person can discern past live? (Vism. XIII, 15) There are 6 kinds of persons who can discern past lives, which are:

- 1) Tittiya-other sectarians
- 2) Pakati Savaka- ordinary disciple of the Buddha
- 3) Mahā Savaka- great disciple
- 4) Agga Savaka- eminent disciple
- 5) Pacceka Buddhas
- 6) Buddha

There are 3 kinds of disciple (Savaka). The eminent disciple (Agga Savaka) for this Sāsana (Buddha's teachings) is Venerable Sarīputta and Venerable Mahā Moggallāna. Only two. For this Sāsana also there are 80 great disciples such as Venerable Ānanda, Venerable Mahā Kassapa, Ven. Mahā Kaccana etc., including Ven. Sarīputta and Ven. Mahā Moggallāna each of whom are entitled foremost in their own qualities. Excluding the eminent disciples and great disciple, the remaining other disciples are called ordinary disciples. Tittiya are those who adopt non-Sāsana teachings. There are people who adopt

non-Buddhist teachings and have Jhāna and Abhiññā. It is also mentioned in the Text. There is a reason to mention them. If even those of other sectarians (Titthiya) can attain Jhāna and Abhiññā then how can one say that in the Buddha Sāsana, where there is a systematic method of practice, Jhāna and Abhiññā cannot be achieved (if one trains and practise towards it)? If the way of practise is correct one can achieve it according to the Pāramī. It depends on the Pāramī. If a meditator has the Pāramī and the way of practice is correct then we cannot say that he cannot achieve it. (Vism. XIII, 16): Other sectarians (Titthiya) can discern as far back as 40 world cycles (kappa) only and not more than that.

How long is the period of one world cycle (Kappa)? The heaping up of the bones of one living being who has been reborn and died, repeatedly, one life after another in one world cycle can be as high as Vepulla Mountain. The life span of a human being at the beginning of a world cycle cannot be reckoned. One is not able to count it by the day or month or year. However, when they start to eat the fertile topsoil, their life span become shorter and shorter until 10 years in life span, with much defilements such as Rāga Dosa Moha and much killing then. Those who survive experiencing the various calamities will then practise the 4 Brahma Vihāra-Loving Kindness (Mettā) Compassion (Karuṇā), Sympathetic Joy (Muditā) and Equanimity (Upekkhā). Then their life span began to get longer gradually until it reaches Asaṅkheyya (incalculable) Then from infinite (Asaṅkheyya) life span it become shorter gradually again until 10 years only. Then from 10 years it gradually reaches up till infinite (Asaṅkheyya) life span again. A pair of these periods of shortening and then extending of the life span is called Antara Kappa (intermediary world cycle). After 64 times of intermediary world cycle (Antara Kappa) then that world cycle will be naturally destroyed accordingly. How long will it be in destruction? The period of destruction will also be 64 times. After the destruction, having nothing in the expanse is also as long as 64 times. The world rain and the arising of the sun, moon, planets and stars, establishing the world are also as long as 64 times. Four times of 64 is one world cycle (Kappa). Since only after 64 times of intermediary world cycle (Antara Kappa) our world will be destroyed, a present-day meditator can discern the period when the contraction or shortening of the life span happened. This is included in the Recollection of Past Life Abhiññā.

Why is it that other sectarians (Titthiya) cannot discern more than 40 world cycles (Kappa)? It is because their wisdom is weak (Vism XIII, 16). One should understand what is meant by 'wisdom' (Paññā) in the Buddha's teaching (Sāsana). Wisdom (Paññā) and Right Understanding (Sammādiṭṭhi) are the same. The Buddha explained what is Sammādiṭṭhi in Mahā Satipatṭhāna Sutta and other Sutta. The insight of the Truth of Suffering (Dukkhasacca) is Right Understanding. The insight of the Truth of Cause of Suffering (Samudayasacca) is Right Understanding. The insight of the Truth of the Cessation of suffering (Nirodhasacca) is Right Understanding. The insight of the Truth of the Way Leading to the Cessation of Suffering (Maggasacca) is Right Understanding. The knowledge, which realizes how to cook rice, is not Paññā, Wisdom. The knowledge, which knows a person's name, is not Paññā, wisdom. So, the other sectarians are weak in the wisdom of the 4 Noble Truths. Why?

(Vism) In the mental process of the other sectarians (Titthiya) it is devoid of the wisdom, which distinguishes physical phenomena and mental factors (Nāmarūpa-pariccheda-ñāṇa) therefore their wisdom is very weak. Because of weakness in wisdom, they cannot discern more than 40 world cycles (Kappa). So you can reckon how powerful is the wisdom, which realizes and distinguishes physical phenomena and mental factors (Nāmarūpa-pariccheda-ñāṇa) in the Buddha's teaching. This wisdom can still be found in the present day. There are "maps" that show how to reach it. These "maps" are still maintained even during the 6th Saṅgha Council. They are not destroyed. Whose duty is it to follow these "maps"? One, who is a disciple of the Buddha.

(Vism. XIII, 16) Ordinary Disciples (of the Buddha) can discern 100 or 1000 world cycles (Kappa) by insight because their wisdom which realizes the Four Noble Truth is powerful. The 80 Great Disciples can discern 100,000 world cycles by Insight. The two Eminent Disciples can discern an infinite age and 100,000 world cycles. Pacceka Buddhas can discern two incalculable ages (Asaṅkheyya) and 100,000 Kappa. These are mentioned with reference to the fulfillments of Pāramī and having received a sure prediction (from a Buddha). Why?

Because the period that they had to accumulate all their Pāramī is only that much respectively. (Ettako hi etesaṃ abhinihāro). 'Abhinihāro' here means all the Pāramī, which bring him towards a direction. Which direction is that? If one wishes to attain as an Ordinary Disciple (Pakati Savaka) Bodhiñāṇa then the fulfilled Pāramī will bring him towards the Ordinary Disciple Bodhiñāṇa. Bring whom? It brings the process of Nāma-rūpa (Mental & Physical Phenomena). Similarly if one wishes to attain the Great Disciple (Mahā Savaka) Bodhiñāṇa then the acquired power of the Pāramī will bring the

process of the Nāma-rūpa towards the Great Disciple Bodhiñāṇa. Then, if one wishes to attain the Eminent Disciple (Agga Savaka) Bodhiñāṇa then the fulfilled Pāramī will bring towards it. And if one wishes to attain the Pacceka Bodhiñāṇa then the accumulated Pāramī will bring towards it. As for Buddha, there is no limitation in their discernment.

Here there are some points that need to be explained for general Knowledge. There are only two Eminent Disciples: Venerable Sarīputta and Venerable Mahā Moggallāna. However there are unique cases. The Venerable Bakkula had accumulated his Pāramī for one incalculable age (Asaṅkheyya) and 100,000 Kappa long. There are chronicles about his accumulation of Pāramī since the time of Anomadassī Buddha Sāsana mentioned in the Apādāna Pāli and Theragāthā Therīgāthā. Similarly, in the case of Yasodharā Therī, she was not an eminent disciple (Agga Savaka) in the Sāsana but she can discern the past till one incalculable age and 100,000 Kappa. Therefore the point that the Great Disciples can discern up till 100,000 Kappa and that ordinary disciples can discern 100 or 1000 Kappas is mentioned generally only. There may be some exception.

The meditator who is going to practise Recollection of Past Lives should know the fact that an ordinary disciple (Pakati Savaka) can discern past lives by means of succession of aggregates, Khandha (Vism. XIII.17). They can also change to discern (the past) deaths and rebirths only, Cuti Paṭisandhi. Some of the meditators who can discern the past lives for many Kappas mentioned that when they discern the past in "queue", they discern only the death and rebirth. They can leave out the middle (i.e. the life period). If they want they can discern what is in the middle (i.e. during the life period). Without discerning the middle (the life period) but discerning towards the past with the intention to know only deaths and rebirths (Cuti Paṭisandhi), he sees only the deaths and rebirths successively, one after the other: death then rebirth, death then rebirth; or rebirth then death, rebirth then death. The 80 Great Disciples' (discernment) is similar to the ordinary disciples (Vism.).

As for the 2 Eminent Disciples, they do not need to discern according to the succession of aggregates (Khandha). After discerning the death (Cuti) of one life they can bypass (i.e. omit the middle) and then discern the rebirth Paṭisandhi of that life. Again when they discerned the death of another life they can bypass to discern the rebirth of that life. They can discern the death and rebirth of one life after another. As for ordinary disciples, in the beginning, when their insight is not sharp yet they have to discern (the past) according to the successive process of the aggregates (Khandha). When their insight becomes sharp they can also discern only the deaths and rebirths. But for the Eminent Disciple they are able to discern only deaths and rebirths from the beginning. Pacceka Buddhas also discern only deaths & rebirths in the same way. As for Buddha they do not need to discern according to the succession of the aggregates and also they do not need to discern the deaths and rebirths one after the other. There are many millions of Kappas in the past. Buddhas can discern any Kappa directly. They can discern any Kappa or any life according to their intention.

(Vism. XIII.19). The light of the Recollection of Past Lives of ordinary disciples is like an oil lamp. As for the Great disciples, their light (of Recollection of Past Lives) is like a torch (ukkā). The light of Eminent Disciples is like Venus (planet). As for Pacceka Buddha the light is like moonlight. The light of the Buddha is like the sunray in the clear autumn sky. Therefore the power of light is not the same.

According to these explanations (from Visuddhimagga), is there light in the Recollection of Past Lives Abhiññā? The past lives are discerned with the light. If this light disappears then the meditator cannot see anything. With this light one discerns past lives. If the light becomes weak the meditator should establish the 4th Jhāna concentration again.

Here (in Mahā Assapura Sutta) the Buddha taught the Recollection of Past Lives to Disciples (Savaka). So, if the meditator wishes to practise Recollection of Past Lives then what should he do? (Vism. XIII 22) The beginner (Adhikammika) who wants to practise the Recollection of Past Lives should go to a secluded place after his meal on return from his alms round. Then in that secluded place he should enter into the 1st, 2nd, 3rd and 4th Jhāna successively. Then one may ask, 'Which Kasina should he choose to enter into the Jhāna?' In this stage the meditator has already practiced the Jhānas – which are Basis for the Abhiññā – skillfully by the 14 ways of Mastery. Now he should again practise the 14 ways for 2 or 3 times. Then choose one of the Kasiṇa – in this case especially the White Kasiṇa – where the light is more powerful. However, for some meditators the light of Fire Kasiṇa is more powerful. Now enter into the 1st, 2nd, 3rd and 4th Jhāna successively of this Kasiṇa (the Kasiṇa which one has chosen). After that emerge from that 4th Jhāna.

(1) What does he do then? He takes the most recent actions in sitting down as the object. Discern by the light. The 'most recent' means the bodily actions in sitting down, immediately before he

concentrates his mind just now. He directs the light on the bodily actions in sitting down. As the meditator has already been successful in discerning the past lives' Avijjā, Taṇhā, Upādāna, Saṅkhāra, and Kamma when he practised Vipassanā, he can now discern the Nāma-rūpa backwards towards the past, beginning with the latest Nāma-rūpa in the actions of sitting down.

(2) Without discerning this way, the object of Recollection of Past Lives can be the Aggregates (Khandha) which includes Supramundane states (Lokuttara dhamma).

(3) Also he can discern the Aggregates of Clinging (Upādānakkhandha) in which the Supramundane states are not present.

(4) Or else he can discern the name concept, town, village, region, the sufferings connected with the Aggregates (Khandha).

The meditator can discern backwards, towards the past by one of these four objects of Recollection of Past Lives. In discerning the latest act in sitting down he can discern exactly how he bends; how he stretches, how he sits. He discerns the bodily postures. Or else he can discern the Mental and Physical Phenomena (Nāma-rūpa), which was arising at the time of sitting. If the meditator attained the Supramundane states (Lokuttara) in that sitting then he can discern the Supramundane States in that posture. If not he can discern the Mundane Mental Physical Phenomena of that sitting. This is what it means.

Then, he further reflects on the preparation of the seat, before he sat down; on entering into the lodging before he sat down; on keeping the alms bowl and robe; on the period of eating; on the period of returning from the village; on the period of wandering for alms in the village; on the period of entering the village for alms-round; on the period of leaving the monastery; on the period of paying homage at the pagoda platform and the Bodhi tree platform; on the period of washing the alms bowl, before going out for alms round; on the period of receiving the alms bowl; on the things done from the time of receiving the alms bowl backwards till the time of washing the mouth i.e. washing the face; on the things done in the early morning; on things done at midnight; on things done at night; in this way he reflects on all things done during the whole day and whole night in reverse order (Vism.).

These reflections are clear to his ordinary consciousness. However if the consciousness is accompanied with Parikamma Samādhi then it is clearer. It is extremely clear (Vism.). In this case Parikamma Samādhi is the Parikamma (preliminary) practised as the Basis of Abhiññā. If while discerning in this reverse order towards the past if something is not clear to the insight what should be done? (Vism. XIII 23)- The meditator should again enter into the 4th Jhāna concentration, which is the Basis for Abhiññā. If the light becomes powerful then he reflects again.

When the light becomes powerful then it is just like a good eyesight person being able to see the various objects in the dark by lighting an oil lamp. This light can shine to see the appearances or forms of the past lives. Concerning about this, the sub-commentary (to Vism.) mentioned this: (Padakajjhānaṃ hi satthakkhassa viya nissandassa sīlaṃ sati paññāmpi nissita bhāvā vahaṃ) the basis Jhāna (Padakajjhāna) is just like the whetstone for sharpening knives. **The 4th Jhāna Basis for Abhiññā has the power to sharpen mindfulness (sati) and wisdom (paññā).** This is because they are matured by entering the 4th Jhāna. The 4th Jhāna is entered not only just now. As one has already **practised the 14 masteries repeatedly**, the power of the 4th Jhāna is matured. That is why if enter into the 4th Jhāna again then the power to sharpen mindfulness and wisdom arises again. Therefore the Commentary mentioned that it is like lighting an oil lamp with the intention that the person with good eyesight could see the things in the dark.

From these explanations, it means that the Parikamma Samādhi consciousness has the power of light. Therefore the sub-commentary to the Pacalāyamāna Sutta (Aṅguttara Nikāya) mentioned the light of Parikamma Samādhi (parikammālokoṇivā) as one of the 4 kinds of light of wisdom. Among the 3 levels of concentration at the Samatha stage: Parikamma Samādhi, Upacāra Samādhi and Appanā Samādhi, the light arises beginning from the Parikamma Samādhi level.

When the past appear or one of the 4 objects of this Abhiññā become clear by means of this light the meditator reflects on the things done, in other words the objects which arose in the past, 2 days ago, 3 days ago, 4 days ago, 5 days ago, 10 days ago, half a month ago, one month ago, 1 year ago, 2 years ago etc. In this way he should reflect on the past 10 years, 20 years until as far back as his own rebirth consciousness (Paṭisandhi) in this life. Discern how many Rūpa Dhamma (Physical Phenomena) and Nāma Dhamma (Mental Phenomena) are there in the rebirth Paṭisandhi. The meditator by then has already been discerning the Nāma-rūpa before reaching rebirth consciousness when he reflected on all 4 objects (of Pubbenivāsānussatiñāṇa) in reverse order. After discerning the Nāma-rūpa of rebirth

consciousness (Paṭisandhi), it is further instructed then to reflect on the occurring Mental Physical Phenomena (Pavattita Nāma-rūpa) at the moment of death (Cutī Khaṇa) in the preceding past life.

According to these two instructions, the righteous one who is going to practise this Abhiññā should have attained at least Nāma-rūpa-pariccheda-ñāṇa (Insight Knowledge of Discerning Physical Phenomena and Mental Factors). He needs to realize Physical Phenomena and Mental Factors. "How should the Physical Phenomena (Rūpa) be discerned? What is Physical Phenomena? How should the Mental Factors (Nāma) be discerned? What are mental Factors?" The meditator needs to realize at least this much. Is it possible to understand this technique (of recollection of Past Lives) without realizing at least the Physical and Mental Phenomena? It is not possible. The wise meditator will be able to discern the Nāma-rūpa at the death moment of the preceding past life, even for the first time of practising (this Abhiññā) stage.

The sub-commentary explained an interesting fact concerning this stage. The 'occurring mental physical phenomena (Pavattita Nāma-rūpa)' means the mental physical phenomena, which are occurring in one because of their respective causes (Pavattita nāmarūpanti attano paccayehi pavattita nāmarūpaṃ).

Among these two -- Mental Phenomena and Physical Phenomena -- that are occurring of the moment of death, which one should be discerned first? It is instructed to discern the Physical Phenomena (Rūpa) first and after that the Mental Phenomena (Nāma) subsequently. However the Apara Teachers instructed to discern firstly the Mental Phenomena and then the Physical Phenomena afterwards. These two methods can be used, according to one's own ability. After discerning the Physical Phenomena, the meditator must then discern the Mental Phenomena. Similarly for those who discerned the Mental Phenomena first must continue to discern the Physical Phenomena. Both Physical Phenomena and mental Phenomena must be discerned. As it mentioned above, the wise meditator is able to discern both Mental and Physical Phenomena.

What kind of "wise person" does it mean? 'Wise person' means the person who had accumulated the (Adhikāra) main merits, which are the basis for Abhiññā. He is the person who had practised and accumulated the Pāramī for Abhiññā in the past. He may be the one who has already attained the Abhiññā then or the one who has not attained it yet but is still practising the Basis for Abhiññā then.

If one is unable to discern the Mental Physical Phenomena occurring at the death moment (Cutī) correctly and if he proceed with the Recollection of Past Lives then the situation will be like that of the other sectarians (Tittthiya). As the insight of Mental Physical Phenomena is not clear, he can discern only some of the Kappa.

The Mental Physical Phenomena, which arose in the past life, had ceased totally and another one has arisen (Vism. XIII, 25, Aññam uppannaṃ = another one has arisen).

The explanation (in the sub-commentary) for 'another one has arisen' (Aññam uppannaṃ) is that the mental physical phenomena, which occurred in the past life ceased totally in the past (*Aññam uppannaṃ idaṃ aññasmā kāmabhavā añño upapatti bhavo uppannoti vuttam addhā paccuppannantara bhāvato* [sub-commentary to Vism]). The mental physical phenomena that arise in the present life are not the same ones. How do they (the present ones) arise? Due to the Avijjā, Taṇhā, Upādāna, Saṅkhāra, Kamma in the past life (or, in other words, due to the Kamma accumulated in the past life), the Paṭisandhi mental physical phenomena called Upapatti Bhava (rebirth) arise in the present life. Did the mental physical phenomena that occurred at the death moment in the preceding past life cross over to this side (i.e. to this present life)? No, they did not.

The discernment of physical mental phenomena that occurred at the death moment of the preceding past life may be in total darkness. It is something very difficult to be seen by those lacking in wisdom [Vism. 25].

The meditator who does not have the ability to discern the mental physical phenomena that occurred at the death moment of the preceding past life should not give up the discernment [Vism.]. Then what should he do?

He should enter into the fourth Jhāna concentration, which is the basis for Abhiññā, again and again repeatedly [Vism.]. There is an advice concerning it. If one finds some difficulties at this stage he should get the help of Āloka Kasiṇa, Light Kasiṇa (i.e. he should enter into the fourth Jhāna of Light Kasiṇa).

In some cases when the Buddha taught about White Kasiṇa then the Light Kasiṇa is included. Also in some cases when the Ākāśānañcayātana Jhāna is taught then Space Kasiṇa (Ākāsa Kasiṇa) is included. Therefore in some cases only eight Kasiṇa are mentioned. Thus, for some meditators, if they establish their concentration by White Kasiṇa then the light can be very powerful. Although the Light is

very powerful by entering into White Kasiṇa, if the meditator is still not able to discern the mental physical phenomena which occurred at the death moment of the preceding past life then he should enter into the Light Kasiṇa again. When the light that arises through the wisdom accompanied with the fourth Jhāna concentration becomes very powerful, then shine and discern again by using this Light.

As he ‘re-practise’ repeatedly for the light of the fourth Jhāna concentration to become powerful, he should reflect on that death moment after each emergence again and again [Vism. 25]. A parable is given concerning this:

A strong man wanted to make a big pinnacle; so he chopped at a very big tree for making the pillar to support the pinnacle. Firstly he chopped at the branches. In doing so his axe became blunted. He was no longer able to use it to chop at the tree. At that time that person should not give up; but should go to the blacksmith to have the axe sharpened. Then he continued to chop the tree. If the axe becomes blunt again then he should again go to the blacksmith as before. When the axe is sharpened he continues to chop at the tree. If he chops again and again like that and when the axe is blunt again he would again go to have it sharpened again and again then there will be a time when this big tree will be fallen down [Vism. 26].

Like this parable, after emerging from the fourth Jhāna, which is the basis for Abhiññā then without discerning the mental physical phenomena backwards from the present (since the meditator initially has already been able to discern the mental physical phenomena up till the present life’s rebirth Paṭisandhi systematically) only discern the mental physical phenomena at the present life’s rebirth Paṭisandhi. After discerning it then in not a long time, leaving aside the discernment of the mental physical phenomena of the rebirth Paṭisandhi, direct the light to the other side (i.e. the past life). Then he can discern the mental physical phenomena, which occurred at the death moment in the preceding past life.

The discernment beginning from the latest bodily actions in sitting down, backwards until the mental physical phenomena of the present life’s rebirth Paṭisandhi cannot be called Knowledge of Recollection of Past Lives yet. It is only the wisdom accompanied with Parikamma Samādhī [Vism 27].

Then, when is the Knowledge of Recollection of Past Lives attained? The meditator who has passed the discernment of the rebirth Paṭisandhi of this side (i.e. of this present life) then discern the mental physical phenomena at the death moment of that side (i.e. of the preceding past life). When he can discern it then the Manodvārika Javana Vithī Citta mind process, which knows the mental physical phenomena of the death moment arise in the Hadaya Vatthu. Its occurrence is like this: Manodvārāvajjana arise for one mind moment; after it has ceased there arise Javana (which take the death moment as object) for four or five mind moments. The first four Javana, which are Kāmāvacara Sensual Realm mental process are Parikamma—Upacāra—Anuloma—Gotrabhū (Preliminary—Access—Conformity—Change of Lineage). The last Javana Citta is Appanā Javana Citta accompanied with the fourth Jhāna called Catuttha Jhānika. The wisdom, which knows the mental physical phenomena of the death moment in the preceding past life and which is accompanying the Appanā Javana Citta is called Pubbenivāsānussatiñāṇa, the Knowledge of Recollection of Past Lives. It arises for one mind moment only. It is the wisdom accompanying the Catuttha Jhāna Javana Citta that arises for one mind moment only.

(Maggabhiññā Sakimatā [Abhidhammattha Saṅgaha]) – The Abhiññā Javana arises for one mind moment only. This one mind moment Javana Citta, as it is accompanied with the fourth Jhāna, has 31 mental factors. Wisdom mental factor (paññindriya) is included in these 31 mental factors. This wisdom is called Knowledge of Recollection of Past Lives.

Through the mindfulness (sati) accompanied with this wisdom one can recollect the processes of the aggregates in the past. The mindfulness recollecting the processes of the aggregates in the past is accompanied with the Pubbenivāsānussatiñāṇa (Knowledge of Recollection of Past Lives). It can recollect 100 lives, 1000 lives, many thousands lives, the aeons (Kappa) [Vism. XIII.27].

Now let us look at what the commentary mentioned about the Kappa in brief. There are three kinds of destruction of Kappa: destruction by water, destruction by fire and destruction by wind. There are also three kinds of the limitations of the destruction: destruction until Ābhassarā, until Subhakiṇhā and until Vehapphalā. The above-mentioned (i.e. the destruction, the beginning and the evolution of the world systems) are included in the objects of Recollection of Past Lives.

(Anekepi saṁvaṭṭa kappe anekepi vivaṭṭakappe anekepi saṁvaṭṭa vivaṭṭakappe) Many destruction of world systems (saṁvaṭṭa kappa), many beginnings (vivaṭṭakappa), many destruction and beginnings (saṁvaṭṭa vivaṭṭakappa) can be discerned. A total of this 4: the destruction, the period of

destruction, the beginning, the period of beginning is called one Kappa. If one is able to discern backwards then an ordinary disciple (Savaka) has the ability to discern thousand of Kappa. This is mentioned generally only.

Great disciples (Mahā Savaka) can discern 1 lakh Kappa. The 2 Eminent disciples (Agga Savaka) are able to discern one incalculable age (Asaṅkheyya) and 1 lakh kappa. Therefore the meditator who is going to practise the Recollection of Past Lives needs to train the mind to be subtle and supple by the 14 ways of mastery. If however the practice is not good and the light becomes weaken, what should he do? He should establish his fourth Jhāna concentration again. If, even though he has established the fourth Jhāna concentration, the power does not become strong, what should he do then? He should practise the 14 ways of mastery again.

Before proceeding further on our topic there are some points I would like to explain to you. It is possible that one can regress from the Abhiññā. It is also possible that one can regress from Jhāna concentration. Concerning regression from Jhāna concentration, the Jhāna concentration is established by meditating on the Paṭibhāga Nimitta of a Kasiṇa. If the Kasiṇa nimitta disappear then one will regress from the Jhāna concentration. Let us take the example of White Kasiṇa practised here. Meditating on the White Kasiṇa, the White Nimitta may disappear and the Jhāna concentration regressed. Then what should the meditator do? He should look for (the cause for) the arising of the nimitta circle.

From where did he progress to the White Kasiṇa meditation? In this case, from meditation on bones. As he progressed to it from bones meditation, now practise bones meditation again. While meditating on bones if the bones disappear (i.e. being unable to discern it), what should he do? As he progressed to bones meditation from meditation on 32 parts of the body, meditate again on the 32 bodily parts. If he is unable to discern the 32 bodily parts then from where did he progress to it? From meditation on the Four Great Elements. Then meditate again on the Four Great Elements. The Four Elements do not disappear. When the concentration on the Four Great Elements becomes powerful then the light will also become powerful. When the Light becomes powerful again then change to meditate on the 32 bodily parts. After meditating on the 32 bodily parts internally and externally thoroughly, change to bones meditation. As soon as the 1st Jhāna concentration is attained by paying attention to the bones as repulsive (paṭikūla), change to paying attention to its whiteness. Then the White nimitta circle will arise. This is the method for finding the nimitta if it disappears.

How to Develop Knowledge of Death and Rebirth of Beings: Divine eye Abhiññā?

After the Buddha had taught about the 11th cause for one to be called a ‘monk’, a ‘samaṇa’, a ‘brahmaṇa’, he then continued to teach the 12th cause: So evaṃ samāhite citte parisuddhe pariyodāte anaṅgaṇe vigatūpakkilese mudubhūte kammaniye ṭhite āneñjappatte sattānaṃ cutūpapātañāṇāya cittam abhininnāmeti. (*Translation:* And he with mind thus concentrated, pure, brilliantly bright, free from lust, free from defilements, pliant, adaptable, stable and unshakable, he inclines the mind to the Knowledge of the Passing away and Arising of Beings)

Immediately before practising the Recollection of Past Lives, the meditator has already practised the fourth Jhāna concentration to fulfil the 8 factors which are: the mind being pure, bright, free from lust, free from defilements, supple, adaptable to the meditation, stable and unshakable. Therefore in this stage, after establishing the fourth Jhāna concentration and fulfilling these 8 factors, the meditator inclines his mind to the Knowledge of divine eye (Dibba-cakkhu), also called the Knowledge of Death (Cuti) and Rebirth (Paṭisandhi) of Living Beings (Cutūpapātañāṇa).

The meditator has the power to choose what he wants to know. He needs to choose what he wants to discern. If he wants to discern past lives then he inclines his mind to the Knowledge of Recollection of Past Lives in reverse. Therefore, in this stage, if he wants to know the death and rebirth of living beings then he needs to incline his mind towards the Knowledge of the Death and Rebirth of Living Beings (Cutūpapātañāṇa), which is included in the Abhiññā of divine eye. The meditator has the privilege to choose. The mind has this power, which is used by the meditator.

At the stage of Recollection of Past Lives, the wisdom, which knows the mental physical phenomena of the past beginning from the last sitting actions backwards till many past lives, arises. The meditator who has attained the Abhiññā of Recollection of Past Lives has already attained the Insight

Knowledge of Discerning Mental Physical Phenomena (Nāmarūpa-pariccheda-ñāṇa). When one attains the Knowledge of Divine eye, what does he see? He sees living beings at the stages of death and at the stages of rebirth; he sees living beings that are inferior & superior; beautiful & ugly; those that have attained birth in one of the four woeful states. He sees living beings reaching (i.e. being reborn in) the respective realms according to their Kamma. Therefore in this stage it involves the Insight Knowledge of Discerning Causal Relationship (Paccayapariggaha-ñāṇa), which discerns Kamma and its effect (So dibbena cakkhunā visuddhena atikkantamānusakena satte passati cavamāne upapajjamāne hine paṇīte suvaṇṇe dubbaṇṇe sugate duggate, yathā kammūpage satte pajānāti).

It is mentioned that the meditator who is practising Vipassanā meditation should know some of the Kamma and its effect. To know all the Kamma and all the effects totally is the scope of Buddha's Omniscient Knowledge (Sabbaññutañāṇa); it is not the scope of disciples (Savaka) [Vism. XIX.17].

The Insight Knowledge of Discerning Causal Relationship (Paccayapariggaha-ñāṇa) can never be fulfilled without knowing any Kamma and its effect at all; that is, the Insight Knowledge of Discerning Causal Relationship can never be attained [Vism.]. Therefore, there is connection between the Insight Knowledge of Discerning Causal Relationship and Kamma & its effect. The meditator who attains divine eye Abhiññā also can attain the Insight Knowledge of Discerning Causal Relationship. He can see not only his own physical mental processes but he can also see living beings reaching to the various lives. He can discern the Kamma through which they reach to those lives.

What are the Kamma he sees of living beings that brings about their arising in the various realms? Some beings have immoral bodily conduct. They are not reluctant to kill others. They are not reluctant to steal. They are not reluctant to commit adultery. There are also those who have immoral speech. They are not afraid to tell lies. They are not afraid to spread malicious gossip. They are not afraid to utter harsh speech. They are not afraid to utter frivolous speech. Furthermore, there are those who have immoral mental conduct. They are not afraid to think of taking others' things illegally. They are not afraid to think of harming others. They are not afraid to accept wrong beliefs. They are full of bad conduct. There are also those who wrongly accuse the Noble Ones (Ariyupāvādaka). This Kamma is a very significant Kamma. If one has wrongly accused an Ariya Noble person, such as the Buddha, then no matter how he tries to meditate he can never attain Magga Phala. [Vism.]

Consider this: Only when the first Magga Phala is attained it can then give rise to the benefit of being free from attaining rebirth in the four Apāya woeful states. It is very difficult to escape from the four Apāya woeful states (i.e. animals, hungry ghost, hell beings, Asuras). For a being, who had been reborn in the animal world, the collection of blood from each of his rebirth as animal (being slaughtered by others) is more than the water collected in the great oceans. It is taught like that in the Text. It is taught that to compare between such collection of blood and the collection of water in the great oceans, the water in the oceans is little. Therefore, it is very difficult to escape from the Apāya woeful state circle. Indeed, it is good to attain such Dhamma, which can save one from getting rebirth in the Apāya woeful states.

However, if one is full of immoral conduct, not being able to stop gossiping maliciously and he also goes on wrongly accusing Ariya Noble Ones then can he attain such Dhamma that can save him from getting rebirth in the Apāya woeful states? No he cannot. However, the Kamma of wrongly accusing Ariya Noble Ones ceased when one apologizes, asking for forgiveness. It is then no longer an obstruction to the attainment of Magga Phala. It is mentioned that he can attain Magga Phala if he then practises the meditation.

There are also those who hold wrong views, especially when they do not accept that there is such a Dhamma as Kamma & its effect. They accumulated bad Kamma when they hold wrong views. After their death, these beings are reborn in woeful states. One can see them with divine eye Abhiññā. It will be explained later concerning the method to practise it according to the Text.

There are those who have good bodily conduct. They abstain from killing others, from stealing, from committing adultery. They also have good conduct in speech. They abstain from telling lies, from malicious gossip, from harsh speech, from frivolous speech. These are the good conduct followed by righteous persons. If one wants to be a righteous person but does not practise the way of a righteous person then can he become a righteous person? No he cannot.

There are also those who have good mental conduct. They do not accuse Ariya Noble Ones. They have right views especially the right view on Kamma & its effect (Kammassaka Sammādiṭṭhi). Right view on Kamma & its effect is included in the right view on the Four Noble Truth. They have accumulated Kamma by having right view. The Kamma accumulated by having these good conduct will bring about rebirth in a good state (Sugati) such as Deva, human beings and Brahma. [Vism.]

Therefore the meditator who has attained the Divine eye Abhiññā can see living beings reaching (i.e. being reborn in) the various realms according to their Kamma. The Buddha gave a parable concerning it. There are two houses facing each other. A man with good eyesight who is standing on the middle of the road could see people entering and leaving both houses. He could also see the people walking and busy with activities inside the houses. In the same way, a meditator with divine eye Abhiññā can see the passing away and rebirth of living beings. The Buddha taught about the practice of divine eye Abhiññā. However he never mentioned that only he could attain it. He taught that a disciple (Savaka) can attain such an insight if they practise according to his teachings. These teachings still exist in the Sāsana now. Although the person attains this insight he has not reach the final objective yet.

It is instructed briefly in the Visuddhimagga on the method to attain this Abhiññā. Concerning the method, the meditator who should have already attained the 8 Samāpatti in each of the 8 Kasina proceeds to practise the 14 ways of mastery. After having practised the 14 ways of mastery, he meditates especially on Āloka Kasiṇa (Light Kasiṇa) and then change to the divine eye Abhiññā. However at the stage of divine eye, some can see only death moment (Cutī) while some can see only rebirth moment (Paṭisandhi). For those who can see only the death moment, without seeing the rebirth of living beings can incline to accept the view that “these beings, when they die comes to an end.” They may accept the wrong view of annihilation, Uccheda-diṭṭhi. As for those who see only the rebirth moment without seeing the death moment of living beings may incline to accept the wrong view of eternalism, Sassata-diṭṭhi. If the meditator can see both the death moment and rebirth moment then the two views of annihilation and eternalism can be removed.

Therefore the divine eye Abhiññā is one of the best ‘weapon’ to remove these 2 wrong views. It (divine eye) is a cause for the purification of view (Diṭṭhi-visuddhi-hetu). In the world, if one accepts wrong views then he will say and do, as he likes. As for the righteous person who has realized by wisdom that “because of unwholesome Akusala Kamma one will be reborn in a bad realm” and “because of wholesome Kusala Kamma one will be reborn in a good realm” then it will not be a burden for him to abstain from immoral conduct; it is also not a burden for him to follow good conduct. Such wisdom can support one to reach a good realm. Therefore while in the rounds of Saṃsāra this is a wisdom, which gives one's dependence. One should try to attain this insight. The wisdom, which can discern both death and rebirth, is a cause of the purification of views.

It further mentioned what the meditator see when he discerns ‘death and rebirth’. Death moment occurs at one mind moment (citta-khaṇa) only and rebirth (Paṭisandhi) also occurs at one mind moment only. Divine eye Abhiññā does not discern these 2 (i.e. the one mind moment of death and the one mind moment of rebirth). They are the concern of the recollection of past lives (Pubbenivāsānussati). As mentioned previously, in the recollection of past lives the meditator discerns the mental physical phenomena of the death moment (Cutī-khaṇa); but it is not the concern of divine eye. From the Vipassanā perspective, this concerns the stage of discerning mental physical phenomena (nāmarūpa-pariccheda-ñāṇa). However, as for the stage of divine eye Abhiññā, it concerns the stage of discerning causal relationship (Paccayapariggaha-ñāṇa). ‘Passing away’ here means the period near death, i.e. those living beings, who are on the verge of death. It is not at the death moment (Cutī). Also the meditator sees the period just after Paṭisandhi and not at the moment of Paṭisandhi (Vism. XIII.76).

Discerning like this, the meditator is able to discern inferior and superior beings. How do the inferior beings reach their inferior state? It is due to the effect of having much delusion. (Vism. XIII.77) Delusion (Moha) means not knowing what is right. When their elders admonish them in accordance with the view of Kamma & its effect they do not follow. They are full of delusion. They are not able to realize that bad conduct will bring about bad effects. Such people are not able to abstain from bad conduct. They do not follow their elders’ admonishment not to do like that. On the other hand, they also have some good conduct to a certain extent only. Having much Moha in their mental process, they will do both bad and good conduct accompanied with delusion.

Doing both good and bad deeds like this, it is like a creeper gourd plant attacked by insects. If that plant is attacked by insects, can it grow into a strong and healthy plant? No, it cannot. Similarly, a good Kamma, which is the cause for rebirth in human world, is ‘attacked’ by the ‘insect’, which is unwholesome deeds (Akusala). That good kamma, being surrounded by unwholesome deeds, is squeezed by it. Therefore, that good kamma cannot give rise to its full effect. It can only cause rebirth in a good realm. The effect is only that much. However, his social status is inferior, his things are inferior. In comparison with others, everything of his is inferior. He attains life as an inferior person because he accumulated inferior kamma in the past. Due to the accumulation of inferior kamma one may be reborn

as an inferior human or inferior deva or inferior brahma. Even if one becomes a brahma there is difference in status among Brahmas. Beings are reborn in different social class accordingly.

There are living beings that are superior. Their clan is of high status; their things are of superior quality; they have high level of education; they also have very wide general knowledge. Everything of theirs is superior. What kamma did they perform that bring about rebirth as superior beings? They accumulated kamma accompanied with wisdom, which is without delusion (amoha nissandayuttatta). What wisdom is it? It is the wisdom, which is the basis of performing the kamma that understands kamma and its effect (Kammassakatā Sammādiṭṭhi). [Vism. XIII 77]

From the perspective of the Four Noble Truths, this Kammassakatā Sammādiṭṭhi is the insight which realizes penetratively that the truth of suffering (Dukkhasacca) arises because of the cause of suffering (Samudayasacca). “Realize penetratively” means: firstly, one realizes the 5 Khandha which exist in 11 ways (past, present, future, internal, external, inferior, superior, gross, subtle, far, and near) called Dukkhasacca, as they really are; then one realizes penetratively that this 5 Khandha arises due to its relevant causes: Avijjā Taṇhā Upādāna Saṅkhāra Kamma. That means he has realized penetratively that Dukkhasacca arises because of Samudayasacca.

If one has not attained this realization yet then it would be the faith (Saddhā) in it through listening to the teachings taught by the Buddha or other noble ones. This is the faith that accepts kamma & its effect through logical reasoning insight. With this right view on kamma & its effect as the predominant factor, one accumulates purified bodily, verbal and mental kamma. With these purified bodily, verbal and mental kamma as the foundation, one practises generosity, morality and meditation as much as he can. What will happen to the righteous person who accumulates these superior kamma? He will become a superior one in whichever realm he is going to be reborn. He will be in a superior status comparing with others.

Consider this: while in the rounds of rebirth, is it better to be in an inferior status or superior status? It is only ‘a little better’. It is only ‘a little better’ because beings of both inferior status and superior status are still not free from the sufferings of old age, sickness and death. Concerning our topic, the following is mentioned in the Sumana Sutta Pali and its commentary.

During Kassapa Buddha’s time there were two monks who were very close friend. However they had different opinion. One of them had the opinion that one should eat the food one got from alms-round only after having shared and offered some of it to other fellow monks. As for the second monk, he had the opinion that while going on alms-round one should accept just sufficient amount. One should not accept more than that. One should not waste things, which are offered by the lay people out of faith; that was his opinion. The two monks discussed about their opinion without coming to a conclusion. One is not able to make the other relinquish his opinion.

Eventually both were in the rounds of rebirth; sometimes they were reborn in human realm, sometimes in deva realm. For the monk who practised generosity, whenever he was reborn in the human realm he was reborn in a superior status; and whenever he was reborn in the deva realm he was reborn in a superior status. As for the monk who did not practise generosity, he was also sometimes reborn in human realm and sometimes in deva realm, but in an inferior status.

During the reign of King Kosala, one of them was born to the royal family while the other was born to a slave woman of the palace. They were both born on the same day. The baby born to the royal family was sheltered under a white umbrella while the slave baby was placed at his feet. Both babies were born with the ability to remember previous births (Jātissara-ñāṇa). In the past, during the time of Kassapa Buddha, they had purifications of morality, concentration and wisdom for 20,000 years. Due to these purifications they were born with Jātissara-ñāṇa, being able to remember one’s own previous births.

Being able to remember thus, the baby prince under the white umbrella said to the slave baby who is at his feet, “How is it now? You did not listen to me then; that is why you are now in an inferior position. Look how superior I am”. The other baby replied, “Don’t boast of yourself like that. The white umbrella, which you are under, is only earth element. There is nothing special about it”. He is telling him not to be conceited of having that earth element. Is he correct? Yes, he is correct. The white umbrella is only a mass of four elements in which the earth element is excess.

According to this narration is there a difference in the effect of practising generosity and not practising it? There is a difference. In this example, it is not that either of them was not pure in morality. Both had purification of morality. It is just that one of them was lacking in generosity. Why was he lacking in it? Because the wisdom called Amoha was not strong in him as it was in the other monk. The other monk had sharp wisdom called Amoha. He believed that while going in the rounds of rebirth, one should have the ‘companion’ called generosity. He had right view. As for the other monk, he did not have

that view. He only had the view that one should not waste things offered by laypeople. Therefore the effects reaped were not the same. One was superior while the other was inferior. The one who accumulated kamma accompanied with Moha became inferior. The other who accumulated kamma accompanied with Amoha becomes superior. Such nature exists.

One can also discern to see beautiful & ugly beings and to know the cause for them to be so by means of divine eye. What is the cause for being beautiful? It is the effect of performing kamma accompanied with metta called Adosa (Vism. XIII). For example, one offers a spoonful of alms-food to a recipient with respect and joy only after having Mettā. If this kamma produce the effect then one will be good looking and loved by others. As one performed the kamma with loving kindness for others, when it produces the effect then one will also be loved by others. This is how the effect is produced. That is, one performs kamma by bodily actions, speech or mind accompanied with loving kindness or non-hatred (Mettā, Adosa).

On the other hand what is cause of being ugly? The kamma done was accompanied with anger (Dosa). From early morning till nightfall one is not pleased with anyone he meets and gets angry for the whole day. Getting angry for the whole day and grumbling, one performs wholesome actions such as offering alms-food, helping others, doing meritorious deeds. As one accumulated such kamma accompanied with anger, what will happen if that kamma produce effect? He may become a person who is not pleasing, not likeable, not adorable by others. Should this person get upset when others do not adore or respect him? No he should not because he accumulated the kamma, which cause others not to be pleased with him. Why? Because the accumulated kamma is accompanied with anger. While performing the kamma he was displeased with the recipient. As he performed the kamma with displeasure, if that kamma produces effect then he will become a person who is not pleasing to others. Isn't this fearful? It is necessary to 'refine' the mind.

It is only the mind that leads living beings to a superior life or inferior life (cittena niyate loko). If one is able to set the mind on a right course then one may become a person with good complexion. If one is not able to refine the mind then one may become a person with unpleasant appearance. Mind is the cause of one's pleasant appearance. Mind is also the cause of one's ugly appearance. Mind is the cause of one's wealth. Mind is the cause of one's poverty. It is due to the mind that one is born in a superior clan. It is due to the mind that one is born in an inferior clan. Therefore it is good to refine the mind. If one does not refine the mind it will naturally lead one to a bad state. There are many meritorious actions that one can perform and the possibility is there that it is accompanied with anger. Examples of some of the meritorious actions are sweeping, respecting, offering flowers, offering oil lamps, offering water, offering alms-food, and offering service to others. If one performs these good kamma 'surrounded' with a displeased mind then when that kamma produces the effect one may become a person who is not pleasing to others.

The meditator can also discern beings that have reached a good state. In other words he can discern those who are rich because of their accumulated kamma accompanied with non-attachment (Alobha). Alobha means non-attachment or non-greed. One is able to offer a packet of candle to a monk if only one is not attached to it. If one is attached to it will he offer it? No, he will not offer it. Being accompanied with non-attachment one offers it. In donating requisites, if one is attached to the price of things will he offer it? No he will not. If there is no attachment then one can offer it. As one performed the kamma accompanied with non-attachment, if this kamma produces effect then he may become a wealthy person.

On the other hand, what is the consequence in performing a kamma accompanied with attachment (Lobha)? When he wants to offer something he has to think about it first. He is indecisive as to whether he should offer or not. He has to ask around. He would say, "Please wait, I can offer it later. Wait for a while, let me think about it." In such a way one has much attachment on the things to be offered. But, unavoidably, he has to offer it. If that is so then this kamma is weak as it is accompanied with Lobha. It (the kamma) is bitten by the 'insect', attachment. As that kamma is accompanied with attachment, if it produces effect then one becomes a poor person. He has only a few possessions. For those with attachment on their possessions it is very difficult for them to have the intention to offer.

It is mentioned "Without bringing along slippers and umbrella, one will regret it in the summer. Without generosity and virtues, one will regret it at the time of death" (Burmese proverb). For those who do not practise meditation, if they also do not practise generosity and virtues then at the time of death, they have nothing to rely on (to bring them to a good state). If they do not have enough generosity to rely on and do not guard their virtues then at the near death moment what kind of kamma object can they rely on? They cannot find anything to rely upon. Therefore, if one wishes to accumulate kamma, which are

reliable for oneself then one needs to refine his mind in order to be free from attachment (Lobha), anger (Dosa) and delusion (Moha).

The rebirths of living beings in their respective realms are discerned according to their kamma. Discerning beautiful beings, ugly beings, dying beings, beings in the first stage of fetus formation, wealthy beings, poor beings etc is the function of divine eye. Discerning that living beings reached their respective realms according to their kamma is the concern of the knowledge of beings reaching (to the various realms) according to their kamma, Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa. However Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa cannot be attained without attaining divine eye. It is the knowledge which arises in the mental process of only those who have attained divine eye; that is, as a consequent of the power of divine eye. Therefore Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa [the knowledge of beings reaching (to the various realms) according to their kamma] discerns precisely the effects of kamma.

The following is the way to attain this knowledge [Vism. XIII, 79]: Establish the concentration by means of White Kasiṇa again. After having made the light more powerful, direct it downwards to hell. If the light of White Kasiṇa is weak then one may change to Fire Kasiṇa, taking fire as the object. However if the light of White Kasiṇa is powerful then it is not necessary to change to Fire Kasiṇa. But if the light is still weak when establishing the concentration by means of White Kasiṇa or Fire Kasiṇa then one should change to Light Kasiṇa, taking sunlight or light of fluorescent light tube as object. The light may become powerful then. Using that powerful light, one can discern hell, directing the mind towards it. If not successful then establish the concentration by means of White, Fire and Light Kasiṇa again and again, one after another. Practise to attain up till the fourth jhāna. As the concentration is established the light becomes powerful; then direct it towards hell. 'Direct the light' means 'making the light more powerful and brighter towards hell'. That is, the light is brighter and more powerful at the place where one wants to discern. Having made the light more powerful and brighter towards hell, one can discern hell beings undergoing great suffering (Vism).

Seeing hell beings experiencing great suffering is the function of divine eye. In this case the explanation of the sub-commentary (Mahā-ṭīkā) needs to be mentioned. I have previously mentioned that the mental physical phenomena, which arise at the moment of death (Cutī) and at the moment of rebirth (Paṭisandhi), cannot be discerned by divine eye. Why is this so? (Sub-commentary): The occurrence of a mind moment as 'arising-static-perishing away' happened for a very short moment only. Also the mental physical phenomena, which arise at the moment of death and rebirth (Paṭisandhi), are very subtle. Furthermore, the object of divine eye is rūpārammaṇa. This rūpārammaṇa must get the support of purejātapaccaya. It means that the rūpārammaṇa must arise previously first, and the divine eye later (api ca dibbacakkhussa paccupanna rūpārammaṇaṃ... taṃca purejātapaccaya bhūtaṃ).

The divine eye Javana called Mahaggata citta cannot arise without Āvajjana and Parikamma before it. In order to attain the Abhiññā Javana, the Parikamma Javana must arise again and again in the preceding. The rūpārammaṇa at the death moment (Cutī) or rebirth (Paṭisandhi) arise for a very short moment only. Rūpārammaṇa last for only 17 mind moments. To attain divine eye Abhiññā, one needs to practise the preliminary (Parikamma) previously. Even before the practice of Parikamma is finished, that rūpārammaṇa has already ceased. Another rūpārammaṇa may arise. To attain divine eye Abhiññā one must practise White Kasiṇa or Fire Kasiṇa or Light Kasiṇa as the Kasiṇa Parikamma (preliminary). Without practising it or, in other words, without Āvajjana and Parikamma, the divine eye Abhiññā Mahaggata citta can never occur.

That rūpārammaṇa can never be the Ārammaṇapaccaya (causal object) of divine eye. This is because while practising the preliminary (Parikamma) for divine eye it has already ceased. While the Parikamma Javana are occurring, the rūpārammaṇa that arose at the moment of rebirth (Paṭisandhi) has already ceased. Therefore the rūpārammaṇa arising then cannot be the object of divine eye. The rūpārammaṇa, which has ceased cannot support the divine eye by Ārammaṇapaccaya Sattī.

Another question in the sub-commentary is this: (Yadi dibbacakkhu ñāṇam rūpārammaṇa meva atha kasmā satte passatīti vuttaṃ) – If the divine eye discerns only rūpārammaṇa (*ultimate reality*) then why does it discern hell 'beings' or any 'beings' (*concept*)? It is mentioned in the commentary (Vism) that when one directs the light towards hell he can discern hell beings in great suffering. It is asked that if only rūpārammaṇa is discerned then why does one discern these 'beings'? It is only stated generally that the rūpārammaṇa, which are arising in the continuity process of beings is discerned; therefore it is mentioned like that (yebhuyyena sattā santānāgatā rūpaṃ dassanato evaṃ vuttaṃ).

Meditators who are successful in the Four Elements meditation and being able to discern physical phenomena will understand what will happen if they discern the four elements again. Only for

those who have sharp wisdom and have attained the Vipassana stages, when they discern the four elements it becomes small particles (kalāpa). If these kalāpa are analyzed then there are at least eight kinds of elements: earth, water, fire, wind, colour, smell, taste and nutritive essence. Among these ultimate realities (Paramattha), the rūpārammaṇa called colour (vaṇṇa) is included. Every kalāpa has rūpārammaṇa called colour. While discerning by divine eye, the form of ‘beings’ – i.e. the continuity process of ‘beings’, sattā santāna – appear when the colour of one kalāpa is compact together with the colour of another kalāpa. Actually the divine eye sees only rūpārammaṇa but, as the rūpārammaṇa of every kalāpa is closely compact with each other, when one discerns these groups of a great quantity of rūpārammaṇa one can say it is the continuity process of ‘beings’. Actually divine eye does not see ‘beings’. Therefore it is explained that generally it is the great quantity of rūpārammaṇa in the continuity process of beings, which is discerned.

Another explanation is: (Sattāggahaṇassa vā kāraṇa bhāvato vohāra vasena vuttantipi kiñci) – it is regarded or accepted as ‘beings’. Since rūpārammaṇa is accepted by people as ‘beings’, that is, according to the vocabulary of people it is called ‘beings’, therefore ‘beings’ is stated. Actually it (divine eye) does not really see ‘beings’. It sees only the rūpārammaṇa, which exist in the continuity process of beings. These are the explanations.

The commentary further explains how the Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa (knowledge of beings reaching to the various realms according to their kamma), which is a category of divine eye, arises. The meditator gives attention thus “Due to having done what kamma do these beings experience such sufferings?” then the insight which realizes the kamma of those beings arises. This insight, which can discern the kamma, is called Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa. From the perspective of Vipassana meditation, this insight is similar to the insight knowledge of discerning causal relationships (Paccayapariggaha-ñāṇa). That insight knowledge in Vipassana stage can realize directly one’s own kamma and its effect. It does not have the power to know the kamma & its effect of external (other) beings individually. As for the scope of Savaka-pāramī-ñāṇa (the insight of Buddha’s disciples), it can discern external (other beings) generally only. However the power of Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa can discern to know exactly the kamma done by beings individually. If it discerns it can know which beings has done what kamma that has now reached to that hell.

How, i.e. using what method, can this be discerned? Firstly the meditator must have already been able to discern the ultimate reality mental physical phenomena (Paramattha Nāma-rūpa) systematically during Vipassana. (In divine eye stage) He then discerns the four elements of the hell beings and analyses its mental physical phenomena. Although one may not be able to know exactly how many mental factors are there in the mental phenomena, one can analyse its physical phenomena. The meditator discerns its (the hell being’s) Hadaya vatthu (heart base). He discerns the physical phenomena in the heart generally. If one can discern its heart base then he will be able to discern that hell beings’ mind clear element, which arise dependent upon the heart base. Then if he discerns this mind clear element backwards successively as a process, discerning from where it derives or proceeds, then he can discern its immoral conduct or unwholesome kamma done in the past life as a human being or an animal etc.

It is the discernment of the mental physical phenomena backwards. The insight, which knows the relationship between that cause and effect is called knowledge of beings reaching (to the various realms) according to their kamma (Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa). It is a category of divine eye. It is not possible to attain this insight without attaining divine eye. As mentioned previously the recollection of past lives Abhiññā involves the insight knowledge of discerning mental physical phenomena (Nāmarūpa-pariccheda-ñāṇa). Only meditators who have realized the ultimate reality mental physical phenomena—conforming to the insight knowledge of discerning mental physical phenomena—can attain Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa.

In vipassanā meditation, it is possible only for meditators who have attained the insight knowledge of discerning mental physical phenomena to try to attain the insight knowledge of discerning causal relationships (Paccayapariggaha-ñāṇa). For the meditator who has not yet realized even the mental physical phenomena, if he tries to discern and look for the cause of mental physical phenomena, then can he realize it in true ultimate reality penetratively since he has already skipped a stage in the practice? No, he cannot because he has bypassed a stage. Since divine eye is practised after the attainment of recollection of past lives, the insight knowledge of discerning mental physical phenomena is already attained.

When the meditator sees the hell beings then, using the light with the help of the power of divine eye, after he has discerned the four elements of that hell being, he analyses the mental physical

phenomena of that hell being. The meditator can know its mental physical phenomena to some extent. The discernment may be powerful, according to the sharpness of the meditator's insight. However, it is not yet easy to discern how many mental factors are there in every mind moment arising in the mental process of the hell being in this Abhiññā. It is the scope of Knowing Others' Mind Abhiññā (Paracittavijjāñā Abhiññā).

(In divine eye) When the meditator discerns the mental process called mind clear element backwards he can see it successively; and if he discerns the physical process backwards, he can also see it successively. Discerning backwards like this, he can know whether this hell being came from human realm or deva realm or animal realm etc. If he further discerns he can know the immoral unwholesome kamma committed by them in that realm. The knowledge of beings reaching (to the various realms) according to their kamma (Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa) arises in the meditator.

Similarly by directing the light upwards in the direction of deva realm he can discern the deities who are living in magnificence in Nandana Grove, Missaka Grove, Pharusaka Grove etc. This (seeing) is only the function of divine eye. It is still not yet the function of the Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa. Having seen them, the meditator then gives attention thus, "Due to what kamma they had performed that they are now experiencing such magnificence." For those with sharp insight, they will know or realize it as soon they discern it. This is Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa.

If the meditator does not realize it immediately then he should firstly discern the four elements of that deity and analyse his mental physical phenomena. Discern his mental physical phenomena backwards until Paṭisandhi (rebirth) gradually. At that time, if he discerns to know from where did the mental physical process come from then he will realize the past life, be it human or deity. How does the meditator further discern the wholesome good kamma accumulated in that (past) life?

He should discern especially the time of near-death (Marāṇasaññā Javana) of that life. He discerns the four elements of that being at the time of near death (on the verge of death), before rebirth as the deity, giving priority to discerning the Bhavanga mind clear element. Due to the force of kamma (Kamma Sattī), one of these three: Kamma or Kamma Nimitta or Gati Nimitta will arise in the Bhavanga mind clear element, producing the effect of rebirth in deva realm.

Let's say that the last nimitta, which appeared is the wholesome good kamma of offering alms-food. When this nimitta appear, discern the four elements, which were arising at the time of accumulating that kamma. Analyse the mental physical phenomena. Discern what aspiration was made at the time of offering the alms-food (Avijjā, Taṇhā, Upādāna). Discern exactly how many mental factors were there in that wholesome mind (kusala citta cetasika) of offering alms-food – whether it is 34 or 33 or 32 etc. Discern the force of kamma (Kamma Sattī) of that wholesome mind. If the meditator discerns the relationship between (1) that force of kamma and (2) the mental physical phenomena that arise at the time of Paṭisandhi then he truly comes to know, "Oh, because of this kamma that being reached the deva realm."

To be able to realize it in that way, the meditator needs to discern the mental physical phenomena of the past life and the mental physical phenomena of the life after that (in this case, the deity life) systematically. In the above case, only the cause and effect (kamma and its effect) are realized. The insight, which realizes kamma and its effect, is called knowledge of beings reaching according to their kamma (Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa). It is the scope of the Knowing Others' Mind Abhiññā (Paracittavijjāñā Abhiññā) to discern the mental factors in every mind moment exactly.

(Vism. XIII, 80) – There is no separate preliminary (Parikamma) meditation to practise in order to attain Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa. Similarly there is no separate preliminary meditation to attain the knowledge of the future (Anāgataṃsa-ñāṇa). Only the divine eye Abhiññā is the basis for them to arise; they arise together with divine eye. That is, if divine eye is attained then Yathā-kammupaga-ñāṇa and Anāgataṃsa-ñāṇa arise. They are branches of divine eye Abhiññā.

The meditator who has attained this knowledge can discern that those beings in their past lives were endowed with good bodily conduct, good verbal conduct and good mental conduct. They had purified bodily kamma, purified verbal kamma, and purified mental kamma. They had kamma accumulated due to having right view. They also encouraged others to have right view. If such person passes away he will be reborn in the deva realm or a good realm. It can be discerned by divine eye Abhiññā.

There is another method in discerning (*mentioned in the Mahā-ṭīkā, sub-commentary*). In this method the meditator who has divine eye Abhiññā discerns (by the light) the near death moment of someone he knew (e.g., a friend or a relative) who has passed away. Analyse the mental physical

phenomena to discern where that process of the arising & passing away of the mental physical phenomena is going towards. He can know by this method whether that person is reborn in a good realm or a bad realm. (This method is explained as follows).

(Evaṃ yassa yassa sattassa samanantarā anāgataṃ attabhāvam ñatukāmo taṃ taṃ odhissa **Ālokaṃ vadḍhetvā** tena tena atīte etarahi vā āyūhitam tassa nipphattakam kammam yathākammupaga ñāṇena disva tena nipphattetabbam anāgataṃ attabhāvam ñatukāmo tādisena samādānena paccayena ca manasikarena parikkhate citte yathāvato jānāti, [sub-commentary]) – The meditator must make the light powerful, directing it towards the being whom he wants to discern. He discerns the near death moment of that being. He will find towards where is that process of mental physical phenomena going when he discerns by the light. When he sees the being reached the deva realm or hell realm he then can discern to know ‘due to what kamma that being reached that realm?’ if he discerns backwards.

In this case the meditator makes the light powerful towards the being he wants to discern; he then discern the wholesome kusala kamma or unwholesome Akusala kamma accumulated by that being at that time. For example if the being accumulated wholesome kusala kamma then discern systematically the mental factors Avijjā, Taṇhā, Upādāna which accompanied that wholesome kusala kamma. Discern whether the life, which he aspired for, will occur in future or not due to the force of that kamma (Kamma Sattī). Similarly if the being accumulated unwholesome Akusala kamma living with immoral conduct, then discern the four elements of that being and analyse the mental physical process. Be able to discern systematically the unwholesome Akusala kamma; discern whether it is accumulated accompanied with Dosa (anger) or with Lobha (greed). After having discerned the kamma, it can be discerned whether he will get the unwholesome effect in future life or not, due to this force of kamma (Kamma Sattī).

These references are like a reliable map. If one meditates according to the instructions of the ‘map’, one can know what the ‘map’ says. In the above (Pāli) reference, ‘**Ālokaṃ vadḍhetvā**’ means ‘having made the light more powerful’. If the meditator wants to discern past lives then— **Ālokaṃ vadḍhetvā** —he makes the light more powerful. If he wants to discern future lives then— **Ālokaṃ vadḍhetvā** —he makes the light more powerful. He makes the light powerful towards where he wants to discern. It can be discerned by the power of the light. Therefore, you can also attain it; you also have a mind.

If you are able to concentrate the mind on one object then the mental states lead by concentration will arise. The power, namely faith, effort, mindfulness, concentration & wisdom will arise. Concentrate deeply on one object and the power will become sharpen; and the light will become powerful. Using the power of that light, one can see the hell realm or deva realm if he directs the light towards that particular direction. If discern further he can realize the kamma accumulated in the past life which caused them to reach such a realm. Moreover one can also discern, based on the kamma accumulated in this life, in which realm will that being be reborn due to that kamma.

This is indeed a very praiseworthy religion. It is not a religion of imagination and fantasy. It is a religion in which the teachings can be realized if one practised it systematically. Therefore it is necessary to maintain this exalted practice, which can give rise to the attainment of insight to know things as they really are. Nowadays many people see the moon as a moon only. They have not yet seen the deities there. Even so for the closest things, for example trees. They see the trees as trees only. They do not see the deities or ghost in the trees. This is the ordinary eye (Pakati) of most people. However if one is able to use the power accompanied with the insight eye, one can see the deities or ghosts of that tree. He can also see the deities of the moon, sun, and stars.

Therefore the practice of Buddhism is not descended from imagination. There are many aspect of the practice, which can be realized penetratively by oneself through practical experience. But the Buddha did not teach that all beings will realize all the practices; only the wise righteous person can realize it. The wise righteous person means those who had planted the Pāramī ‘seeds’ in the past. If the meditator is the one who has ‘Vijjā-seed’, ‘Carāṇa-seed’ and is able to practise systematically then he can realize it. This is the teaching with the attribute Ehipassika, ‘come and see’. It is an invitation to practise, to test it practically for oneself. If you are a righteous person who has the appropriate Pāramī then you can attain this power to discern.

Concerning the practice to attain this power, it is briefly mentioned in (Burmese) Visuddhimagga second volume page 58, paragraph 412 (English Vism, XIII, 95). The meditator who starts to practise divine eye must enter into the basis jhāna (Padaka jhāna), which takes Kasiṇa as the object and is the basis for Abhiññā. Here one must practise to be able to discern towards where one wants to discern. It means to try to meditate until the light becomes powerful so that the direction where one wants to discern

can be easily seen. How to try to be able to meditate thus? As mentioned previously, it is based on the practice of the 14 masteries.

First, enter the 8 attainments (Samāpatti) of each of the eight kasina and then practise the 14 masteries of them again and again. The light will then become powerful. If he wants to discern the deva realm he practises the light to be powerful to direct towards it. The sub-commentary mentioned that if hell and deity realms are mentioned it includes all the 31 realms. Practise so that the light, the wisdom becomes powerful to be able to send them towards the direction where one wants to discern. After this practice (i.e. the 14 masteries), the meditator must bring to neighbourhood/access concentration in one of these three kasinas: Fire, White or Light Kasina. The light of these three kasina is powerful. However the best among them is not the same for everyone. For some, Fire Kasina is very bright. For some others, Light Kasina is very bright. For some others, White Kasina is very bright. Why is it not the same among meditators? This is because the light is more powerful in the subject of meditation (Kammaṭṭhāna), which had been practised well in the past life. Therefore, enter into the fourth jhāna of one of these three kasinas again and again. Having emerged from that fourth jhāna, maintain the concentration at the Upacāra Samādhi (neighbourhood/access); and then extend the light. Emerging from the fourth jhāna, making the light more powerful and extending it is called the Parikamma (preliminary).

Having emerged from Jhāna, maintain it at the Upacāra Samādhi level; do not re-enter into the Jhāna. Having extended the light discerns only the rūpārammaṇa within the scope of the extended light; discern the rūpārammaṇa on the way of the light, not at the side. If one tries to discern all the rūpārammaṇa here and there, everywhere then it is going beyond the scope of the preliminary (Parikamma). *[Similarly in the Ānāpānassati meditation one should not look at other things but only the Ānāpāna nimitta; if not the light will disappear. Also in the practice of Four Elements meditation do not look at other things other than the four elements or else the light will disappear. Therefore, at those stages do not try to investigate. One's insight to investigate is not perfect yet. Therefore one must take care not to go astray from the meditation object at the stage of establishing the concentration.]*

When the light becomes powerful, the meditator may need the help of his Adhiṭṭhāna Pāramī (determination). Having extended the light, he determines “Let there be light there” at the place where he wants to discern. That is, after delimiting that much of a place where he wants to discern, he determines “Let there be light there”. There will be light within the determined delimitation. If successful in determining thus things that cannot be seen by the ordinary eye can be seen (by the divine eye). For example

- (1) Anto kucchigatam (Vism, XIII, 99) – things inside the belly can be seen. In the practice of Samatha-Vipassana, if the light becomes powerful through establishing the concentration then the 32 parts in the body can be seen. It is also mentioned in the Text.
- (2) Hadaya vatthu nissitam (Vism) – one can discern the mental factors, which arise dependent upon the heart basis (Hadaya vatthu). Why can it be discerned? The meditator who is able to discern the Hadaya vatthu can discern the host Bhavanga mind clearness. If the bhavanga mind clearness is discerned it means that the basis (vatthu) called sense door (dvāra) is also discerned. If that meditator discerns a sense object, let's say, he discerns the visual object (rūpārammaṇa) then when that rūpārammaṇa (visual object) is discerned it impinges on the eye clear-element (cakkhu-pasāda) and Bhavanga mind clearness simultaneously. When it impinges, the bhavanga mind clearness stopped (occurring) and the Vithī citta mind process occurs. This Vithī mind process can be discerned. This is the power of the light. Therefore if the light disappears it cannot be discerned. So it is necessary to understand that light occurs during the Bhāvanā citta (meditating mind) of Samatha-Vipassanā meditation.
- (3) Hetṭha pathavī tala nissitam – the meditator can discern what is underneath the ground or earth's surface. Once there was a meditator who tried to test this power. During one of his sitting meditation session, he discerned underneath the ground below his seat. He discerned the colour of the earth, one layer after another. After that meditation session, he dug up the ground to see whether what he discerned is true or not. He found that what he discerned was correct. Therefore the light can be used like that.
- (4) Tirokuḍḍa pabbata pākāra gatam – one can discern outside the wall to see what exist there. He can also discern the rūpārammaṇa covered by forest and mountains.
- (5) Paracakkavāḷa gatam – the rūpārammaṇa of another universe can be discerned.

These various rūpārammaṇa are seen by the divine eye. It is as if seen by the ordinary eye. Concerning this, we may ask a meditator at the stage of meditation on 32 parts of body, “Do you actually

see the 32 parts of your body, as if looking at the mirror?” If he truly sees the 32 parts as if looking at the mirror then they can progress to kasiṇa meditation. If it is not like looking at the mirror but it is seen by guessing or imagination then one will not be able to be successful in the meditation. Also in the practice of Ānāpānassati, the meditator can actually describe whether their nimitta is circular or not. If the meditator imagined a circular white nimitta then he will not be successful. Actually only the nimitta which appeared due to the power of concentration can be used to progress in the meditation. Similarly the various rūpārammaṇa are seen as if by the ordinary eye.

Having this power to discern rūpārammaṇa may be an obstacle to an ordinary mundane person. When that person determines the light to be spread towards the places where he wants to discern then that light will shine uninterrupted, penetrating through the earth, ocean and mountain; and when that meditator may find fearful rūpārammaṇa such as Yakkha, Rakkhasa, etc; then he may become frightened. If the meditator becomes frightened then his mind gets shaken and he regresses from the Jhāna concentration. Therefore the meditator who is going to discern the various rūpārammaṇa by divine eye should be the righteous person who has mindfulness, not forgetting (Appamāda). Mindful, not forgetting that there are such beings living in the 31 realms of existence. One needs to understand that these beings exist not because one is discerning them. Beings of the 31 realms of existence are always present.

This knowledge is called Cutūpapāta-ñāṇa because it knows the death (Cutī) and rebirth of living beings. It is also called Dibbacakkhu Abhiññā (divine eye) because it is like the eyes of deities; it is explained thus in the Text.

May all beings practice Sīla, Samādhi and Paññā, which are the prerequisites for liberation!

May all beings be able to reach the yonder shore of Nibbāna!



Pa-Auk Tawya Sayadaw Bhaddanta Āciṇṇa in Korea, 14 November 2008



Pa-Auk Tawya Sayadaw Bhaddanta Āciṇṇa & Sayadaw U Revata in Korea, 29 November 2008